ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Time Management for Students: Beat Procrastination Without Hating Yourself

Practical systems for a timetable that survives real campus life

STUDY SKILLS

Study Skills

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Most procrastination is not laziness; it is avoidance of ambiguity, fear or exhaustion. This pack explains why we delay, then gives a practical system: fixed commitments, priority tasks, time blocks and honest weekly reviews.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Identify the main causes of your own procrastination.
- Build a weekly plan around fixed commitments and protected study blocks.
- Break large tasks into next actions that can be started in ten minutes.
- Run a weekly review that improves the plan instead of abandoning it.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Why we delay

Procrastination is an emotional regulation problem more often than a scheduling one.

- Task is vague: 'read biology' has no clear first action.
- Task feels threatening: fear of doing it badly leads to not starting.
- Task is boring and the phone is entertaining.
- Energy is low because of poor sleep or irregular meals.
- Perfectionism turns a 200-word draft into a blocked project.
- Name the cause honestly; the fix differs for each one.

The planning system

Keep it simple enough to maintain on a bad week.

1. List fixed commitments: lectures, labs, fellowship, work, travel.
2. Block sleep, meals and exercise first; they are not optional leftovers.
3. Add study blocks for your highest-priority courses.
4. Each block gets one specific outcome, written as a verb.
5. Keep a capture list for new tasks instead of acting on them immediately.
6. Review the week on Sunday and adjust one thing only.

> **Two-minute start**
> Commit to two minutes of the task. Starting is the hard part; momentum usually follows. If it does not, you have learned the task needs to be broken down further.

Protecting focus

Attention is the scarce resource, not time.

- Phone on silent, out of sight, or in another room during a block.
- Use a 40-minute block with a five-minute break; longer only if genuinely absorbed.
- Batch messaging and social media into defined windows.
- Study in the library or a quiet classroom if the hostel is chaotic.
- Say no to low-value commitments with a specific alternative time.
- Track actual study hours for one week; estimates are usually inflated.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Give three causes of procrastination.

Answer: Vague tasks, fear of failure and low energy. Boredom and perfectionism are also common.

2. What makes a good study block outcome?

Answer: A specific, achievable action such as 'solve five quadratic problems', not 'study maths'.

3. Why schedule sleep and meals before study?

Answer: They are prerequisites for attention; treating them as leftovers produces unreliable study time.

4. What is the two-minute start?

Answer: Committing to begin a task for two minutes to overcome the initial resistance to starting.

5. How should you respond when a weekly plan fails?

Answer: Review the cause, adjust one element and continue. Abandoning the plan guarantees no improvement.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] List all fixed commitments for the week.
- [ ] Write your top three procrastination triggers.
- [ ] Create five specific study-block outcomes.
- [ ] Track actual study hours for seven days.
- [ ] Try the two-minute start on the task you most avoid.
- [ ] Batch social media into two windows per day.
- [ ] Run one Sunday review and change one thing.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date: